

INVISIBLE WOMAN

The Fantastic Four's female presence

INVISIBLE WOMAN

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Susan Storm Richards

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT 5 ft 6 ins

WEIGHT 120 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Blonde

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four Vol. 1 #1

(November 1961)

POWERS

Can turn herself invisible, and is able to project energy around other people or objects that makes them invisible too; can generate protective force fields, or shape invisible objects of psionic force. By projecting force fields beneath her, she can travel through the air.



Actress Susan Storm had already struck up a romance with the scientist Reed Richards when she volunteered to join him on an experimental mission into space. Along with her brother Johnny Storm and the starship's pilot Ben Grimm, Sue received a mutagenic dose of cosmic rays that gave her the power to turn invisible at will. The others had also received superhuman powers, and Sue became a member of their new team, the FANTASTIC FOUR, under the identity of the Invisible Girl. Sue's powers evolved over time, giving her the ability to project impenetrable force fields and to turn objects invisible through mental control.

COSMIC POWERS

Sue soon married Reed, and battled threats to Earth including planet-devouring GALACTUS. Complications with her first pregnancy forced Reed to stabilize her labor with the



energies of ANNIHILUS' Cosmic Control Rod, and Sue gave birth to a boy, Franklin RICHARDS. She briefly separated from Reed and left the Fantastic Four, allowing MEDUSA to fill her spot. Sue's second pregnancy ended in a stillbirth. During this vulnerable period, PSYCHO-MAN controlled Sue's mind and caused her to assume the villainous identity of Malice. After shaking off Psycho-Man's influence, Sue called herself the Invisible Woman.

Sue and Reed briefly joined the AVENGERS, but returned to their original team. After Reed's apparent death at the hands of DOCTOR DOOM, Sue served as the Fantastic Four's leader, rejecting romantic overtures from NAMOR the Sub-Mariner. It transpired that the child from Sue's earlier stillbirth had been preserved in another dimension by Franklin. After a battle with Abraxas, the unborn girl returned to Sue's womb and soon after became her daughter Valeria.

During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), Reed's efforts on behalf of SHIELD (and the ILLUMINATI) disgusted Sue.



She left Reed and sided with CAPTAIN AMERICA's resistance. At the start of the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7), the Skrull named Lyja replaced Sue, but Sue herself later escaped.

An older Sue Richards from a possible future recently led her DEFENDERS into the present day to save eight billion refugees to Nu-World, a synthetic copy of Earth. She died at the hands of DR. DOOM, but her friends continue her work as the Fantastic Force. **DW, MF**



Sue can shape her force fields into tentacles that grasp and stab. Here, she unleashes her rage on Doctor Doom.



Sue's ability to generate force fields is more versatile than her power of invisibility, making her one of the team's strongest members.



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Secret Wars II #2

Sue assumes the villainous identity of Malice while under the influence of the Psycho-Man.

• *Fantastic Four* Vol. 1 #284

It's goodbye to the venerable codename Invisible Girl, as Sue reinvents herself as the Invisible Woman.

• *Fantastic Four* Vol. 3 #54

Sue gives birth to her second child, Valeria Richards, assisted in the delivery by the Fantastic Four's archenemy, Doctor Doom.